DESIGN
HOMEBAR

WHERE DESIGN MEETS INDULGENCE

No longer defined by function alone, the present-day home bar is shaped by proportion, light, material, and the subtle choreography of use.

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The home bar has grown up. What began as a lockdown necessity during Covid—a place to recreate the ritual when bars were closed for business—has evolved into one of the most considered spaces in the contemporary home. Not a cabinet tucked away or a trolley wheeled out, but a room within a room, designed as much for atmosphere as function. The shift reflects something larger in luxury interiors. Excess has given way to intention. Where ostentation once signalled wealth, restraint now foretells taste. The materials are still exceptional, think onyx countertops, smoked glass cabinets, aged walnut, leather and brushed brass, but deployed with precision.

Lighting does the heavy lifting. Backlit shelving that shifts with the hour and integrated systems responsive to voice or app. Alongside it, the objects: a monogrammed decanter, single malts and glassware chosen for weight as much as form. Architects and designers now treat these spaces with the rigour once reserved for kitchens or libraries. Proportion matters and so does the sequence, right from when you enter, how the light changes, and where you choose to sit. Here are some well-curated home bars that don't announce themselves but create the cosy nooks that let you enjoy the drink.





Clockwise from top right: Soonawala Mansion bar cabinet; Prakash Manzil bar; Liberty Tower cabinet, all in printed, distressed leather and wood from Portside Cafe Furniture Studio